INTERNAL STRATEGY DOCUMENT

Organic & Paid Lead Generation Strategy

A complete, actionable playbook for growing candidate and client pipelines across the DACH region through content, community, and performance marketing.

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A 12-part guide, from strategic foundations to a ready-to-run 90-day roadmap.

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HOW TO PRESENT THIS TO YOUR TEAM

Each section is designed as a standalone slide-ready block: one core idea, a short rationale, and concrete next steps. Walk through Sections 3–8 first (the "what to do"), then Sections 10–12 (the "how we'll run it").

01 Executive Summary

The short version of this entire document — read this first, use the rest as reference.

ChauTech Consulting places Fullstack Developers, Cloud Engineers, DevOps Consultants, Business Analysts, and UI/UX Designers on freelance and contract terms across the DACH region. Growth depends on two parallel pipelines that must be filled continuously: **candidates** (skilled freelancers/contractors willing to work on our projects) and **clients** (companies with open roles or IT consulting needs). This guide sets out how to grow both pipelines using a combination of **organic marketing** (content, SEO, social, community, video) and **inorganic/paid marketing** (LinkedIn Ads, Google Ads, retargeting, sponsored placements).

The core idea in one sentence

> **STRATEGY IN BRIEF**
> Organic content builds long-term trust, SEO visibility, and a reusable content library at near-zero marginal cost; paid campaigns amplify our best organic content and target high-intent searches to generate leads faster — the two are run together, not separately.

What "organic" and "inorganic" mean here

Type	Definition	Examples in our context
ORGANIC	Unpaid reach — earned through content, SEO, and relationships. Slower to build, cheaper long-term, and builds trust/ authority.	LinkedIn posts, blog articles, SEO, newsletters, community engagement, video, employee advocacy.
INORGANIC	Paid reach — you pay per click, impression, or lead to accelerate visibility to a specific audience.	LinkedIn Ads, Google Search/Display Ads, sponsored job listings, retargeting, paid influencer/partner posts.

What good looks like in 90 days

3×/week	2–3	1	Monthly
ORGANIC CONTENT PUBLISHED	ALWAYS-ON PAID CAMPAIGNS LIVE	LEAD-GEN LANDING PAGE + FUNNEL PER PERSONA	KPI DASHBOARD REVIEWED WITH LEADERSHIP

Guiding principles for the team

- ✓ **Two audiences, two messages:** never mix candidate-facing and client-facing messaging in the same post or ad — the value proposition is different for each.
- ✓ **Content before ads:** we do not pay to promote content that hasn't first proven itself organically (engagement, saves, comments).
- ✓ **DACH-first, English-fluent:** German-language, locally compliant content for DACH decision-makers; English content for the wider international freelancer/contractor pool.
- ✓ **One source of truth:** every campaign — organic or paid — must point to a tracked landing page, not just the homepage.
- ✓ **Measure before scaling:** no budget increase on a channel without at least 2–4 weeks of performance data.

02 Where We Stand: Market & Audience

Understanding who we are talking to shapes every content and ad decision that follows.

Market context

ChauTech operates in the DACH IT freelance/contract staffing market — a segment defined by high demand for niche technical skills (cloud, DevOps, fullstack), fast-moving client hiring cycles, and freelancers who are frequently approached by multiple agencies at once. Differentiation comes less from "we have candidates" and more from **speed, technical credibility, transparent process, and consistent visibility** in the channels this audience actually uses — primarily LinkedIn, technical communities, and search.

COMPLIANCE FLAG

Any claims about placement numbers, client names, day rates, or "years of experience" used in marketing materials must be verified internally before publishing — especially for tenders and proposals. Do not invent statistics to make content sound more impressive.

Two primary audiences (buyer personas)

👤 Candidate Persona — "The In-Demand Contractor"

Fullstack Developer, Cloud Engineer, DevOps Consultant, Business Analyst, or UI/UX Designer working freelance/ contract in DACH. Receives multiple recruiter messages weekly; decides based on **project quality, rate transparency, communication speed, and agency reputation**.

Wants to see: real project examples, transparent rates/process, fast responses, respect for their time, proof ChauTech understands their tech stack.

🏢 Client Persona — "The Hiring Manager / IT Procurement Lead"

CTO, Head of IT, HR/Procurement lead, or Business Analyst manager at a DACH company needing to fill a technical role quickly or bring in specialist consulting capacity.

Wants to see: proof of relevant placements, speed-to-shortlist, compliance knowledge (Scheinselbstständigkeit / German contractor status), industry expertise, and a low-friction way to submit a brief.

Where each persona spends time

Channel	Candidate persona	Client persona
LinkedIn	High — follows tech content, job posts, thought leadership	High — primary B2B research and outreach channel
Google Search	Medium — searches for "freelance [role] Projekte", rate benchmarks	High — searches for "IT Freelancer vermitteln", "[role] Berater finden"
Freelance platforms (freelancermap, Malt, GULP)	High	Medium
Tech communities / Slack / Discord / Reddit	Medium–High	Low
YouTube / short-form video	Growing — career & tech content	Low–Medium
Email newsletter	Medium (if genuinely useful, not spammy)	Medium (market insight, salary/ rate reports)

Section 2 continues into channel-specific tactics in Sections 4–8. Use this persona table as the filter for every content and ad idea: "Which persona is this for, and where do they actually spend time?"

03 The Growth Model: Organic + Paid Together

The framework every campaign in this guide follows.

The funnel we are building

Stage	Goal	Organic role	Paid role
Awareness	Be visible where candidates & clients look for expertise	LinkedIn posts, SEO articles, video	LinkedIn awareness ads, display retargeting seed
Consideration	Prove credibility and relevance to their exact need	Case studies, niche blog posts, newsletter	LinkedIn lead-gen ads, Google Search (mid-intent keywords)
Conversion	Get the form filled / CV submitted / brief received	Landing page CTAs, community DMs	Google Search (high-intent), retargeting, sponsored job posts
Retention	Keep placed contractors and past clients engaged for repeat business	Alumni newsletter, LinkedIn engagement, referral asks	Light retargeting to past converters for new roles/services

Why we don't treat these as separate teams

The single biggest inefficiency in B2B lead gen is running paid ads to weak content, or creating great organic content that never gets amplified. The fix is a simple weekly rule:

> **THE 70/20/10 AMPLIFICATION RULE**
> Every week, look at organic post performance. The top ~20% performing organic posts (by engagement rate, not just impressions) get a small paid boost (€20–€100) to extend reach to a targeted audience. This turns proven content into paid creative — never the reverse.

Budget philosophy

Organic marketing costs time, not media spend — its "budget" is consistent hours from the content/social team. Paid marketing should start small and scale only against evidence:

- **Test phase (Month 1):** small, diversified budget across 2–3 channels to find signal.
- **Scale phase (Month 2–3):** shift 70–80% of paid budget to the 1–2 channels with the best cost-per-qualified-lead.

- **Maintain phase (ongoing):** always keep 10–15% of paid budget as an "experiments" bucket for new formats/channels.

04 Organic Strategy — Content & SEO

The owned-content engine: website, blog, and search visibility.

Website & SEO priorities

Technical SEO checklist

- ✓ Fast load time on mobile (test with PageSpeed Insights)
- ✓ Clean, descriptive URLs per role/ service page
- ✓ German + English versions with proper hreflang tags
- ✓ Schema markup for JobPosting on open roles
- ✓ SSL, sitemap.xml, and robots.txt correctly configured

On-page content priorities

- ✓ Dedicated landing page per role type (Cloud Engineer, DevOps, etc.)
- ✓ Dedicated page per core service (freelance placement, consulting)
- ✓ Fresh blog content published consistently (see calendar below)
- ✓ Client & candidate testimonials with real, verified quotes

Target keyword themes (research and refine monthly)

Persona	Keyword theme examples (DE)	Keyword theme examples (EN)
Candidate	"Freelance Projekte Cloud Engineer", "DevOps Freelancer Stundensatz"	"freelance DevOps contracts Germany", "IT contractor rates DACH"
Client	"IT Freelancer vermitteln Hamburg", "Cloud Berater kurzfristig finden"	"hire freelance fullstack developer Germany", "IT staffing agency DACH"

Use a keyword tool (Google Keyword Planner, Ahrefs, or Ubersuggest) to validate search volume before committing content resources — don't guess.

Blog / article content pillars

Pillar	Purpose	Example titles
Role & skills guides	SEO + candidate trust	"What Clients Actually Look for in a Freelance Cloud Engineer in 2026"
Rate & market reports	Lead magnet for both personas	"DACH Freelance IT Rate Benchmark — H2 2026"
Compliance & process	Client trust, differentiator	"Scheinselbstständigkeit erklärt: Was Auftraggeber wissen müssen"
Case studies	Proof, mid-funnel conversion	"How We Staffed a 6-Person DevOps Team in 3 Weeks"
Industry trends	Thought leadership, top-of-funnel	"5 Cloud Skills DACH Employers Are Paying a Premium For"

DACH LOCALIZATION FLAG

Rate benchmarks, compliance content (Scheinselbstständigkeit, AÜG/ Arbeitnehmerüberlassungsgesetz where relevant), and legal terminology must be written or reviewed in German by someone with local market/legal familiarity — do not machine-translate compliance content.

Publishing cadence (organic content engine)

Channel	Frequency	Owner
Blog article	1–2 per week	Content & Lead Gen Manager + freelance writer/SME review
LinkedIn company page post	3–5 per week	Content & Lead Gen Manager
Newsletter (candidates)	Bi-weekly	Content & Lead Gen Manager
Newsletter (clients)	Monthly	Content & Lead Gen Manager + Sales input

05 Organic Strategy — Social Media & Community

LinkedIn-first, with selective presence elsewhere.

Channel priority for a B2B tech recruiting brand

Channel	Priority	Primary use
LinkedIn	Primary — 80% of organic social effort	Thought leadership, job posts, client & candidate stories, employee advocacy
Instagram	Secondary	Employer branding, team/culture content, behind-the-scenes video
X / Twitter	Optional, niche	Tech community engagement, developer conversations
Reddit / Discord / Slack tech communities	Selective, high-trust	Genuine participation, never overt selling — build reputation first
YouTube / Shorts / TikTok	Growing priority	Video content distribution (see Section 6)

LinkedIn content mix (weekly rhythm)

ORGANIC

Content types that work for recruiting brands

- ✓ Open role announcements with real project detail (not generic job ad copy)
- ✓ "Day in the life" of a placed contractor
- ✓ Market insight / rate trend posts with a simple chart
- ✓ Team & culture posts (humanizes the brand)
- ✓ Client success stories, framed around the outcome, not just the logo
- ✓ Short opinion/POV posts on hiring trends from leadership

Employee advocacy program

Consultants and recruiters resharing/commenting extends reach far beyond the company page alone.

- ✓ Give the team a monthly "easy share" post with pre-written caption options
- ✓ Encourage personal posts about placements they're proud of
- ✓ Track which employees consistently drive engagement/leads

Community management guidelines

- **Respond fast:** comments and DMs answered within 24 hours on business days — speed is a competitive differentiator in staffing.
- **Never hard-sell in communities:** in developer/tech communities, contribute genuinely useful answers first; mention ChauTech only when directly relevant and disclosed.
- **Tone:** professional but approachable — avoid corporate jargon; write like a knowledgeable colleague, not an ad.
- **Escalation:** negative comments or complaints get moved to DM/email quickly and calmly; never delete legitimate criticism without response.

> **QUICK WIN**
> Repurpose every long-form blog article into 3–4 LinkedIn posts, 1 carousel/infographic, and 1 short video clip. One piece of research becomes a week of content — this is the single highest-leverage organic habit to build.

06 Organic Strategy — Video Content

Video is the highest-engagement organic format on LinkedIn and the fastest-growing on search (YouTube).

Video content formats, by effort level

Format	Effort	Best for	Cadence
Talking-head clips (30–90s)	Low	Market insight, quick tips, "myth vs. reality" on freelancing/hiring	Weekly
Interview / testimonial videos	Medium	Client & candidate proof, trust-building	2× per month
Explainer videos	Medium	Process explainers ("How placement works"), compliance topics	Monthly
Event / conference recap	Medium	Employer branding, community presence	Per event
Polished brand/ corporate video	High	Website hero, sales decks, major campaigns	1–2× per year

Production workflow

Step-by-step: from idea to published clip

1. **Plan:** pull the topic from the content calendar — always tie the video to a specific persona and funnel stage.
2. **Script/outline:** a 3-bullet outline is enough for short-form; full script for explainer/ testimonial videos.
3. **Shoot:** phone-quality is acceptable for talking-head content if lighting and audio are good — invest in a basic lavalier mic and ring light before a camera upgrade.
4. **Edit:** add captions (most LinkedIn/Instagram video is watched muted), a branded intro/outro bumper, and a clear on-screen hook in the first 3 seconds.
5. **Distribute:** native upload to LinkedIn and YouTube (never just a link — native video gets far more reach); repurpose into Shorts/Reels.
6. **Repurpose:** pull 2–3 quote graphics or a carousel from every video's key points.

Video for paid amplification

WHERE VIDEO MEETS PAID

Testimonial and explainer videos are the strongest-performing creative for LinkedIn Lead Gen ads in B2B services — plan at least one "ad-ready" video per quarter, filmed and edited with paid distribution in mind (subtitles, vertical + horizontal versions, clear CTA at the end).

07 Inorganic Strategy — Paid Social & Search

Where every euro of paid budget should go first.

LinkedIn Ads — the primary paid channel

Ad format	Use case	Notes
Single image / text ads	Awareness, role announcements	Cheapest entry point; good for testing messaging
Video ads	Employer branding, testimonials	Use captions; keep under 30s for cold audiences
Lead Gen Forms	Client brief requests, candidate CV submission	Pre-filled LinkedIn data = higher conversion than external landing pages for cold traffic
Document ads / carousels	Rate reports, market guides as lead magnets	Strong for capturing mid-funnel B2B leads
Conversation ads	Direct candidate outreach at scale	Use sparingly — can feel intrusive if overused

Targeting approach

PAID Candidate campaigns

Target by job title (Fullstack Developer, Cloud Engineer, etc.), skills, and "self-employed"/freelancer profile fields, location (DACH + relevant EU countries), and member groups for freelance tech professionals.

PAID Client campaigns

Target by job title (CTO, Head of IT, HR/ Procurement, IT Director), company size, industry, and seniority; layer on company lists for account-based targeting where available.

Google Ads

Campaign type	Intent level	Example use
Search — branded	Very high	Protect brand searches ("ChauTech Consulting") from competitors bidding on the name
Search — high-intent	High	"IT Freelancer vermitteln", "hire cloud engineer contract Germany"
Search — role-specific	Medium–High	"DevOps Consultant freelance Projekt", per-role landing pages
Display — retargeting	Warm audience	Re-engage website visitors who didn't convert (see Section 8)
YouTube ads	Awareness/ consideration	Pre-roll on testimonial/explainer video, targeted by in-market audiences

COMPLIANCE FLAG — PAID CAMPAIGNS

Ad copy referencing salaries, placement guarantees, or specific timelines ("we place you in 48 hours") must be accurate and defensible — German advertising and labor-market regulations (e.g. around AÜG for temporary staffing) are stricter than in many other markets. Legal/compliance sign-off before launch on anything guarantee-like.

Starting budget split (illustrative — adjust to actual budget)

Channel	% of paid budget (test phase)	Rationale
LinkedIn Ads	50%	Highest-intent B2B audience for both personas
Google Search	30%	Captures active, high-intent searchers
Retargeting (Google Display + LinkedIn)	15%	Cheap, high-conversion warm traffic
Experiments (YouTube, sponsored newsletters, niche job boards)	5%	Ongoing discovery of new channels

08 Inorganic Strategy — Retargeting, Job Boards & ABM

The rest of the paid toolkit — lower cost, often higher conversion.

Retargeting funnel

Warm audiences, in order of proximity to conversion

1. **All website visitors (30 days)** → general awareness ad reminding them who ChauTech is.
2. **Visitors to a specific role/service page** → targeted ad matching exactly what they viewed.
3. **Landing page visitors who didn't submit the form** → strongest offer (e.g. free rate benchmark download) to recover the lead.
4. **Past clients/candidates (CRM list upload)** → "new roles/services available" nurture ads.

Sponsored job boards & freelance platforms

Platform	Best for
freelancermap	Candidate sourcing — sponsored/featured listings for hard-to-fill roles
GULP / Malt	DACH freelance marketplace visibility
LinkedIn Jobs (promoted)	Dual-purpose — visible to both candidates and referral sources
Niche tech job boards (e.g. WeAreDevelopers, StackOverflow Jobs where relevant)	Specialist roles (Cloud, DevOps) with lower competition than generalist boards

Account-Based Marketing (ABM) — for high-value client targets

For a defined list of target client accounts (e.g. mid-size DACH companies with recurring IT hiring needs), combine:

- LinkedIn company-list targeted ads served only to employees at named target accounts
- Personalized outreach sequences (sales-led, marketing-supported with tailored one-pagers)
- Retargeting ads triggered only after a target-account contact visits the site

WHY ABM FITS RECRUITING

Staffing/consulting sales cycles often involve 2–4 stakeholders per account. ABM ensures the CTO, the HR lead, and the procurement contact all see consistent, relevant messaging — rather than one cold outbound email doing all the work.

Paid vs. organic — quick decision guide

Situation	Use organic	Use paid
Building long-term SEO authority	✔	
Need leads within 2–4 weeks for a specific hard-to-fill role		✔
Testing a new value proposition or offer	✔ (cheap, fast feedback)	✔ (once validated, scale with paid)
Reaching a named list of target accounts		✔ (ABM)
Building employer brand / trust over time	✔	✔ (amplify best organic content)

09 Landing Pages & Lead Capture

Where organic and paid traffic both need to convert.

Minimum landing page set

Page	Audience	Primary CTA
"Hire a [Role]" pages (one per role)	Client	Submit a brief / book a call
"Find Freelance Projects" page	Candidate	Submit CV / create profile
Rate benchmark / market report download	Both (segmented by form field)	Download in exchange for email
Campaign-specific pages (per ad campaign)	Whoever the ad targets	Matches the exact ad promise — never redirect ad clicks to the homepage

Landing page conversion checklist

- ✓ Headline restates the exact offer/promise from the ad or post that brought the visitor here
- ✓ Form asks for the minimum fields needed — every extra field reduces conversion
- ✓ Clear trust signals: real testimonials, logos (only with permission), certifications
- ✓ Mobile-first layout — most social traffic arrives on mobile
- ✓ One CTA per page — no competing links pulling attention away from the form
- ✓ Thank-you page/email sets clear next-step expectations ("we'll respond within 24 hours")
- ✓ UTM parameters on every campaign link so the source is trackable in analytics

AD COPY TONE REMINDER

Keep ad and landing page copy professional but approachable — direct, benefit-led sentences over corporate buzzwords. "Get matched with vetted DACH clients in days, not months" outperforms "Leveraging our synergistic network of enterprise partners."

10 AI Tools & Marketing Automation Stack

A lean, prioritized stack — not an exhaustive tool list. Add tools only once a real workflow need appears.

Function	Recommended approach	Notes
Content drafting & ideation	Claude for first drafts of posts, articles, ad copy, and email sequences	Always human-reviewed for factual accuracy before publishing, per compliance guidance
Social scheduling	Buffer or Hootsuite for cross-platform scheduling	Centralizes LinkedIn, Instagram, X publishing and basic analytics
SEO research & tracking	Ahrefs or Semrush (or Ubersuggest as a lighter/cheaper option)	Monthly keyword and ranking review
Email/newsletter automation	Mailchimp, Brevo, or HubSpot (depending on existing CRM)	Segment candidate vs. client lists — never send the same email to both
Landing pages & forms	Unbounce, HubSpot, or the existing website CMS if flexible enough	Prioritize speed of publishing new campaign pages over design complexity
CRM & lead tracking	HubSpot or Pipedrive	Single source of truth for lead source, stage, and outcome
Video editing	CapCut (fast, caption-friendly) for short-form; Premiere/DaVinci for polished pieces	CapCut's auto-caption feature is a major time-saver for weekly clips
Analytics/ reporting	Google Analytics 4 + native LinkedIn/ Google Ads dashboards, consolidated into one monthly report	See Section 11 for the KPI framework

AUTOMATION QUICK WIN

Set up a simple automation: new landing page form submission → auto-tag by persona (candidate/client) in the CRM → auto-notify the right internal owner → auto-enroll in the matching nurture email sequence. This alone removes hours of manual lead routing per week.

ONE RECOMMENDATION TO START WITH

If only one automation is implemented this quarter, make it lead routing + tagging (above) — it directly protects response-time speed, which is one of the strongest differentiators candidates and clients mentioned in Section 2.

11 KPIs, Reporting & Budget Allocation

What to track, how often, and how to read it.

Core KPI set

Metric	Tracks	Review cadence
Website traffic (organic vs. paid vs. direct)	Overall visibility	Weekly
Keyword rankings (target list)	SEO progress	Monthly
LinkedIn engagement rate (not just followers)	Content resonance	Weekly
Cost per lead (CPL), by channel and campaign	Paid efficiency	Weekly during active campaigns
Lead-to-qualified-lead conversion rate	Lead quality, not just volume	Monthly
Qualified-lead-to-placement/client-won rate	Full-funnel effectiveness	Monthly/quarterly
Landing page conversion rate	On-page effectiveness	Per campaign
Email open/click rate, by segment	Nurture effectiveness	Per send

A NOTE ON NUMBERS IN THIS GUIDE

This document intentionally does not include target numbers (traffic goals, CPL targets, conversion benchmarks) because these should be set from ChauTech's actual historical data and budget, not industry averages. Bring current numbers (traffic, spend, lead counts, close rates) to the next planning session and we'll set realistic, specific targets together.

Reporting rhythm

Cadence	Format	Audience
Weekly	Short internal check-in: what's live, early signal on paid campaigns	Marketing team
Monthly	Full KPI dashboard + narrative summary of wins/learnings	Leadership
Quarterly	Strategy review: what to double down on, what to cut	Leadership + Sales

Budget allocation framework (organic vs. paid effort)

60%
TIME ON ORGANIC CONTENT & SEO

25%
TIME ON PAID CAMPAIGN MANAGEMENT

15%
TIME ON REPORTING & OPTIMIZATION

Illustrative split for a single-person or small marketing team — adjust based on actual headcount and paid budget size.

12 90-Day Roadmap & Team Roles

The concrete starting plan — what to actually do, in order.

Phase 1 · Days 1–30 — Foundations

- ✓ Audit current website SEO, LinkedIn page, and analytics tracking setup
- ✓ Define/confirm the two personas and finalize messaging pillars for each
- ✓ Build the first 2 landing pages (one candidate, one client)
- ✓ Set up CRM lead tagging and routing automation
- ✓ Publish first 4 weeks of organic content from the calendar (Sections 4–6)
- ✓ Launch small test budgets on LinkedIn Ads and Google Search (test phase split, Section 7)

Phase 2 · Days 31–60 — Build Momentum

- ✓ Review first-month paid data; reallocate budget toward best-performing channel
- ✓ Launch retargeting campaigns across website visitors
- ✓ Publish first rate benchmark / market report as a lead magnet
- ✓ Start employee advocacy program with a monthly easy-share post
- ✓ Produce first 2 testimonial videos (candidate + client)
- ✓ Begin ABM pilot with a short list of 10–15 target client accounts

Phase 3 · Days 61–90 — Optimize & Scale

- ✓ Run the first full monthly KPI review with leadership
- ✓ Scale budget into the 1–2 best-performing paid channels
- ✓ Expand landing page set to cover all core roles/services
- ✓ Formalize content calendar for the next quarter based on what performed best
- ✓ Evaluate need for additional tools/automation from Section 10
- ✓ Set specific, data-backed KPI targets for the next 90 days

Suggested team roles

Role	Responsibility in this plan
AI Content & Lead Gen Manager	Owns strategy, content calendar, paid campaign management, reporting
Recruiters / Consultants	Supply real project stories, testimonials, and technical accuracy checks; employee advocacy
Leadership / Sales	Reviews compliance-sensitive claims, approves ABM target list, monthly KPI review
External support (as needed)	German-language/legal review for compliance content; freelance video editor for high-effort pieces

This guide is a living document. Revisit Sections 11–12 every quarter to update targets, reallocate budget, and refine the content calendar based on real performance data.